Rebuttal to Argument Against Measure Y

The opponents ask voters to fear what Measure Y might someday become. Voters should instead judge **Measure Y by what it actually says and does.**

Measure Y is a deliberately limited charter.

It gives Benicia one additional authority: the ability to enact the real property transfer tax proposed in Measure Z, and nothing beyond that. It does not change Benicia's council-manager form of government.

It does NOT give the City Council new authority to raise its own compensation. And it does NOT impose a tax on its own-Measure Z takes effect only if **Benicia voters approve both measures.**

Most importantly, Measure Y does NOT give City Hall a blank check to expand the Charter later. Any future amendment or expansion of the Charter would require voter approval. Benicia voters remain in control.

That is the central issue: who should decide Benicia's future? **Measure Y keeps that decision with the people of Benicia.**

Benicia faces significant change in the years ahead. New development and redevelopment will place additional demands on:

- Roads
- Public safety
- Infrastructure
- Other essential services.

Measure Y simply gives local voters the legal ability to decide whether the property-transfer-tax structure in Measure Z should help meet those needs.

Measure Y is narrow, transparent, and voter controlled. Everything else about how Benicia is governed remains subject to California general law unless voters themselves choose otherwise.

Protect local decision-making. Keep voters in charge.

Please join us in voting YES on Measure Y.



/s/ Wendi S Phillips
/s/ Allison Costelow
/s/ Terence Bennett
/s/ Stephen Young